

5G tester market to be worth US\$ 629 million by 2019

The sales volume of 5G testers will thrive impressively at around 14 per cent in 2019, Future Market Insights has projected in a new report. The report estimated that the 5G tester market valuation will exceed US\$ 629 million in 2019, witnessing a bullish 14.6 per cent increase over the value attained in 2018. Nearly 75,000 5G testers were sold in 2018. More than 40 per cent of the total demand is expected from telecom providers. Demand growth of 5G tester is likely to gain more prominence in the automotive industry over the course of next few years, the report added.

Wipro launches IIoT centre of excellence in Kochi

Wipro has announced the launch of its Industrial Internet of Things (IIoT) centre of excellence (CoE) in Kochi, India. The CoE marks Wipro's commitment to developing innovative IIoT solutions that span across the technology stack for its customers in the industrial manufacturing, automotive, healthcare and pharmaceutical, consumer products and goods, and utilities space. Leveraging artificial intelligence (AI), blockchain and robotics, the lab will develop proofs of concept and market-ready IoT solutions in an iterative agile development model.

telecom equipment vendors, including Huawei, in the world and moving to block the Chinese company would not be good for the industry. "This is not a Vodafone topic; it is an industry topic. Huawei plays a major role in the supply chain (of telecom equipment). If you look at it from our perspective, we have resiliency and security in our networks. If we concentrate on just two players, it is not healthy," PTI quoted Vodafone CEO Nick Read as saying.

Huawei has been facing scrutiny in many countries over espionage concerns. The US has asked its allies to ban the use of 5G gear from Huawei, expressing concerns that its alleged link with the Chinese government could pose a national security threat.

In India, Vodafone's joint venture Vodafone Idea has partnered with Huawei for 5G trials.

Tata Power Solar launches residential rooftop solution in Kolkata

Tata Power Solar Systems, India's largest solar energy company and Tata Power's wholly-owned subsidiary, has launched a complete residential rooftop solution in Kolkata. The residential rooftop solution is expected to save up to ₹ 50,000 annually for 25 years. This decreases the use of diesel generators, hence leading to more fuel savings. Apart from this, consumers can avail a chance to earn from their idle rooftop space. To further ease the beneficiaries' expenses, the proposition comes with government subsidy.

Gurugram to set up its first government-sanctioned EV charging station

Gurugram is all set to install its first charging station for electric vehicles (EVs) on National Highway 48, adjacent to Rajiv Chowk intersection. The deputy commissioner's office signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with a private firm. According to a report in the *Hindustan Times*, the project will be the first government-sanctioned EV charging facility in the city, at an establishment cost of ₹ 1.3 million.

Tesla to enter India by 2019, says Elon Musk

Elon Musk is not giving up on the potentially huge but largely undeveloped electric vehicle (EV) market in India, saying that he "would love" Tesla to be there in 2019 or 2020.

Tesla has not yet started making EVs in India because of some challenging government regulations, Musk said in May 2017. He also said, "Maybe I am misinformed, but I was told that 30 per cent of parts must be locally sourced and the supply does not exist in India yet to support that."

A month later, in June, Tesla's CEO said that he was "in discussions with the government of India requesting temporary relief on import penalties/restrictions until a local factory is built."

Although, India and China are similarly sized in terms of their huge populations, India is lagging behind

China in terms of passenger EV adoption, with just 6000 passenger EVs as compared to China's 1.35 million passenger EVs, according to data from Bloomberg NEF.

In August 2018, Bloomberg NEF (BNEF) analysts said that India was more focused on electrifying public transport, taxis and three-wheelers, which comes at the expense of private passenger EVs. "We remain optimistic on India's e-bus market, but do not expect large numbers of passenger EVs to be sold until the latter half of 2020," BNEF analysts said.

LED lights mandatory in all government and commercial buildings: Haryana transport minister

Use of LED lights has been made mandatory in all government buildings, industries and commercial organisations in Haryana. The state's transport minister Krishnan Lal Panwar said this while addressing a gathering on energy conservation at a conference held in Gurugram, attended by the ministers for new and renewable energy from all states and union territories.

As per a report in the *Times of India*, Panwar emphasised the importance of promoting energy conservation. The state government is also providing LED bulbs of 9W at a concessional rate of ₹ 20, in various villages across Haryana. "Two LED bulbs are being given to each household, and around 115,000 families are supposed to be covered under the programme," the report quoted Panwar as saying.

According to the minister, the two power utilities in the state—Uttar Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam and Dakshin Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam—have raked up over ₹ 4 billion under Ujwal Discom Assurance Yojana (UDAY) scheme, which involves state governments taking up a part of the debt of discoms to facilitate financial revival. "Under UDAY scheme, power distribution companies achieved a financial turnaround two years ahead of time and earned a profit of ₹ 4.12 billion in 2017-18," the minister added.

UDAY scheme was launched by Union Power Ministry in 2015 to resolve the chronic financial problems of state discoms.